JONAH BUTTERBAUGH

ACCOUNT TAKEOVER & FRAUD INVESTIGATOR | TRUST & SAFETY OPERATIONS

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SUMMARY

Account-takeover and fraud investigator with more than a decade of experience across marketplace risk, banking, business cards, and insurance. At Expedia Group, handles roughly 30 account and supplier-risk cases each day using SQL, Splunk, device and identity intelligence, transaction data, and OSINT. Experienced in distinguishing legitimate-customer compromise from intentional or coordinated abuse, writing defensible case decisions, mentoring investigators, and turning recurring operational problems into repeatable processes. Builds frontier-AI safety, security, research, and agent-governance tools outside work, with an emphasis on authorization, auditability, and human control.

CORE SKILLS

Investigations: Account takeover, credential compromise, fraud investigation, incident response, payment and merchant fraud, refund and chargeback abuse, OSINT, coordinated abuse

Data and tools: SQL (Querybook), Splunk, Tableau, Redshift, Qubole, ThreatMetrix, Iovation, Ekata, Pipl, Accurint, LexisNexis

Operations: Evidence-based dispositions, multi-signal correlation, escalation, investigation reporting, mentoring, quality review, process improvement, KYC, AML, OFAC, BSA

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EXPEDIA GROUP | Account and Supplier Risk Investigator I | Springfield, MO | Jul 2024-Present

- Investigate roughly 30 account and supplier-risk cases each day involving account takeover and credential compromise, payment and merchant fraud, refund and chargeback abuse, AML alerts, OFAC concerns, bot activity, and suspected collusion.
- Correlate account, transaction, device, network, identity, and behavioral signals using ThreatMetrix, Iovation, Ekata, Pipl, Accurint, LexisNexis, and Expedia fraud tools.
- Use SQL through Querybook alongside Tableau, Splunk, Redshift, and Qubole to trace actor behavior, identify related activity, and support documented dispositions and escalations.
- Apply evidence-based judgment to distinguish legitimate-customer compromise from intentional or coordinated abuse while considering platform risk and unnecessary customer impact.
- Investigated and disrupted several high-impact travel fraud events; document findings, rationale, and escalation paths in clear case notes.
- Mentor newly trained investigators on evidence collection, case prioritization, and consistent investigation workflows.

SELECTED AI SAFETY, SECURITY, AND RESEARCH PROJECTS

Egregore | Private security and model-safeguards project

- Built a dependency-free Node.js CLI that consolidates security-scanner findings and model-judgment tests behind fail-closed authorization, scope, evidence, and human-approval gates.

Recursive Estimator Folding | White-Box Estimation Challenge research

- Developed a structured Kerdock/MUB spherical-quadrature estimator with exact radial conditioning for the 2026 AIcrowd challenge; tied experiments to graded submission #326094 and maintained reproducibility, ablation, provenance, and negative-result ledgers.

Eidolon and Authored Agent Skills | Private and public projects

- Built reusable scaffolding for approvals, safety hooks, persistent memory, and operating rules; authored trust-but-verify, dual-log-memory, and ai-pairing-playbook to support audit discipline, traceability, and practical human-agent collaboration.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EXPEDIA GROUP | Senior Advocate (Lead), Premium Service | Aug 2022-Jul 2024

- Advanced from premium-service agent to lead; owned direct-report scheduling, 1:1 coaching, quality reviews, trend reporting, and manager coverage.
- Introduced the SERVE escalation framework; rollout increased organization-wide metrics by 15% and reduced avoidable self-escalations.
- Led analysis of latency and dropped work in the Citrix payment environment; findings supported a workflow refactor and creation of a dedicated Payments team.
- Anchored incident bridges during global call-routing failures, coordinating with engineering and maintaining operational continuity through resolution.

JPMORGAN CHASE | Account Representative II, Business Credit Card | Aug 2021-Jun 2022

- Handled fraud holds, fraud-claim intake, dispute lifecycles, chargebacks, account unlocks, and regulated business-card servicing.
- Reviewed account logs for access patterns consistent with account takeover; applied KYC, AML, OFAC, and BSA controls and routed cases to fraud specialists.
- Managed cases involving cryptocurrency fraud, elder financial abuse, and KYC scams.

TTEC (USAA) | Licensed Property and Casualty Agent | Mar 2018-Jun 2021

- Used LexisNexis, CLUE, and motor-vehicle-report data for policy risk assessment while binding and servicing policies across multiple insurance lines.

TTEC (USAA) | Senior Banking Specialist, Deposits | Mar 2015-Mar 2018

- Analyzed account histories, transaction patterns, and MFA-protected access logs to identify elder financial abuse, credential fraud, impersonation, and scam activity.
- Filed KYC and AML reports under federal requirements and identified and reported suspicious transfers and OFAC sanctions concerns.
- Led the Deposits chat team, trained new hires, and authored a coaching model that became the program standard.

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Lean Six Sigma White Belt | Regulatory training in KYC, AML, OFAC, BSA, anti-fraud, and social engineering | Technical training in SQL, Splunk, Tableau, data scrubbing, attribute-based fraud inference, and communications review

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Hollister High School | Hollister, MO | 2006

Gibson Technical Center | Graphic Design Program | Reeds Spring, MO | 2004-2006